



Association
of National
Olympic
Committees
of Africa

ACNOA - ANOCA

ACNOA

SPECIAL
EDITION

REVIEW OF AFRICAN OLYMPISM

M A G A Z I N E

THOMAS BACH
**AFRICA
SAYS**

Thank You!

The outgoing IOC President leaves after bequeathing to Africa a precious and impressive legacy. All of Africa pays him a glowing tribute.





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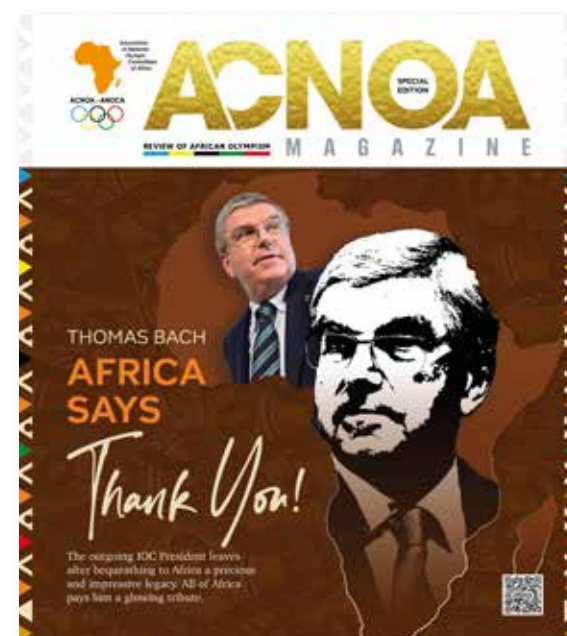
AFRICAN
NOCs







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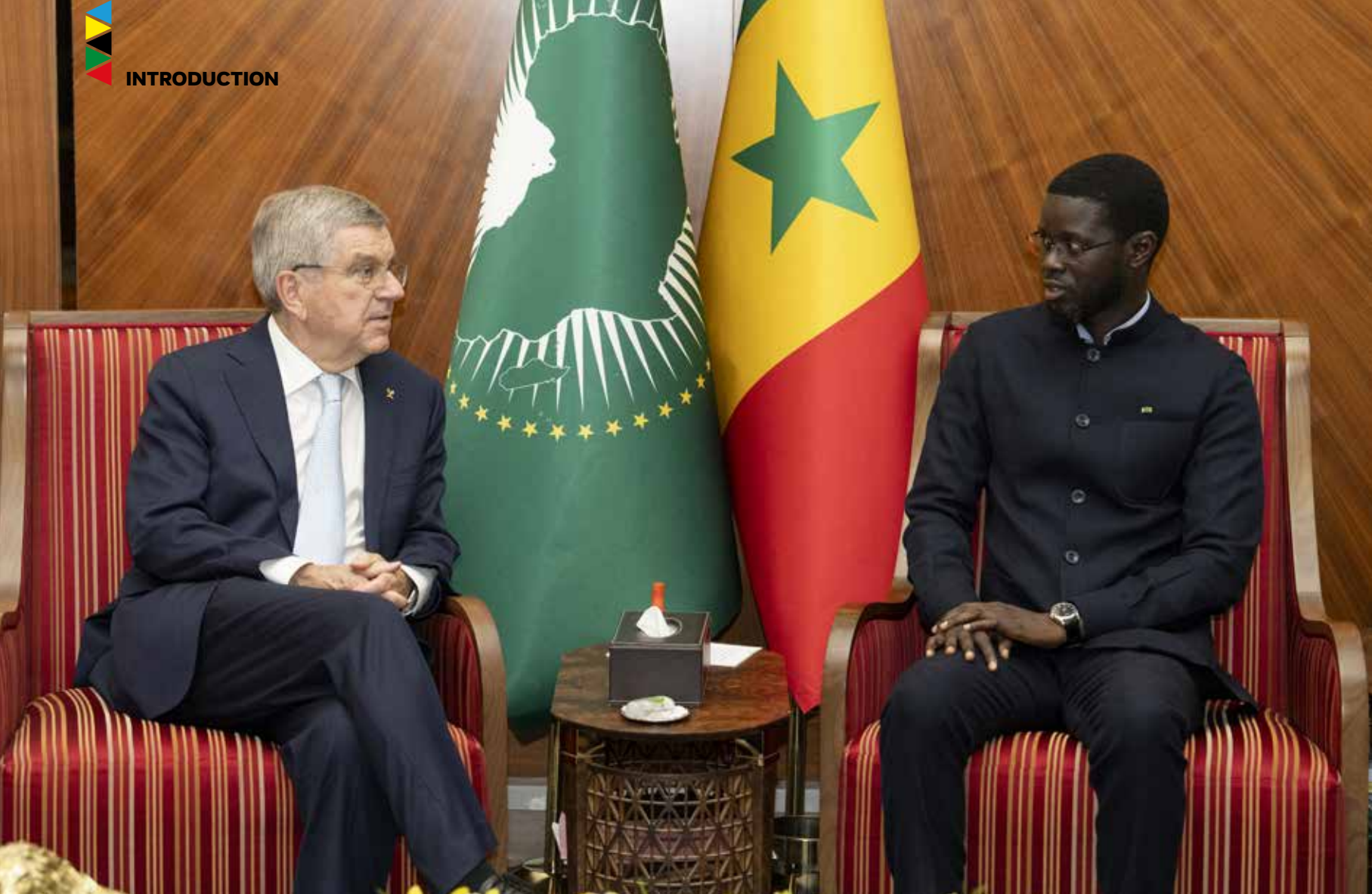
INTRODUCTION

TRIBUTE TO THOMAS BACH

A GREAT FRIEND OF AFRICA

He is one of those iconic figures whose commitment goes beyond mandates and whose vision leaves an indelible mark on the history of institutions.





President Thomas BACH embodies that unique greatness that is driven by strong convictions, openness to others and undying loyalty to the universal values of Olympism. He has never seen sport as just a competition, but as a lever for societal transformation, the foundation of human dignity and a tool for dialogue among peoples, in a nutshell, an ideal platform to express Olympic values.

During his twelve-year tenure at the helm of the IOC, he championed a shared and humanistic ambition: to make sport a driver of peace, inclusion and development globally. And while this ambition burned across five continents, there is no gainsaying it reverberated the most in Africa.

Under his stewardship, Africa continued to rise, taking its place, henceforth recognised, no longer for its difficulties, but for its exceptional potential.

Furthermore, Africa's status within the big Olympic family changed from observer to actor. Moving from the sidelines to a land of opportunities and promise. President BACH saw Africa not as a continent on the sidelines, but as a vital force, a driving force for reinvention and resilience for the future of world sport. By fostering a balanced and inclusive approach, he helped African NOCs become more autonomous, credible and ambitious.



By concluding many partnerships, supporting young athletes, strengthening African NOC structures, and believing in Africa's potential, he did more than just implement programmes: this great friend of Africa built trust, sowed the idea that excellence transcends borders, that the Olympic podium must be accessible to all nations, and all young people. He inspired a paradigm shift in which every young African girl or boy can freely dream of reaching the pinnacle of world sport.

This special magazine stems from this gratitude. It reflects a continent that remembers, pays tribute and resolutely looks to the future. Readers will find herein not just the testimonies of champions and leaders, with photos of meetings and figures that speak volumes, but also a magazine laden with respectful silence. It is a testament to an era and a vision, a common course taken by one man and a continent, driven by the same faith in Olympic values.

Through these pages, ANOCA seeks to create a memorial, erected in ink and commitment, to the one who understood that Africa was not asking for handouts, but for opportunities that befit its status.

This special feature also seeks to pass on to and remind succeeding generations that the future of sport is built through mutual recognition, true cooperation and a shared desire to elevate humanity.

May this tribute serve as a compass and a momentum for future generations so that the Olympic spirit can continue to radiate across the African continent with grandeur and dignity. Although all of Thomas BACH's achievements have secured a chapter for him in history, it is his human qualities that have earned him a place in the hearts of all Africans.



**"THANK YOU,
PRESIDENT BACH,
FOR BELIEVING IN AFRICA"**





On behalf of ANOCA, we wish to pay a special tribute to President Thomas BACH for his unwavering support to the African Olympic Movement during his twelve-year tenure.

On behalf of all African NOCs, volunteers, our athletes, our officials, our hopefuls, we heartily say: Thank you, President Thomas BACH, for believing in Africa and for giving her the means to believe in herself. We are honoured by your actions, inspired by your track record, and committed by your legacy.

VISIONARY LEADERSHIP

President BACH, you demonstrated your visionary leadership by working to promote sport and Olympic values in Africa. Your commitment to sport development on the continent was exemplary, and helped drive significant progress. Your tangible actions were the hallmark of your leadership and results followed without any speculation.



Like a devoted soldier working tirelessly for a noble cause and hungry for victory, you were elected Honorary IOC President after twelve years as President. Thanks to your vision, the continuity of the Games is assured, and the Olympic Movement has been elevated to the rank of leading player for tolerance, solidarity, development and peace, despite the contrasting geopolitical situations around the world.

Thanks to your great wisdom, Olympic Agenda 2020+5 has been a landmark for the entire African Olympic Movement in particular, and the global Olympic Movement in general. Your actions can be summed up in two words: credibility and solidity.

UNWAVERING SUPPORT

ANOCA is grateful for your unwavering support for our National Olympic Committees. You understood the needs and challenges of our various

Sport development in Africa has made giant strides thanks to your leadership. Olympic Solidarity programmes help train coaches and athletes, build sports infrastructure and promote Olympic values."

countries and designed programmes to enhance our development. You will certainly be present in Dakar 2026 to celebrate the Youth Olympic Games, a major competition you worked hard for it to be organised in Africa. You wanted it and Africa got it, which symbolises your trust in our continent.

TANGIBLE OUTCOMES

Sport development in Africa has made giant strides thanks to your leadership. Olympic Solidarity programmes help train coaches and athletes, build sports infrastructure and promote Olympic values.

African athletes took part in the Olympic Games unperturbed, because you made the Olympic Games a haven of solidarity and peace. You achieved parity between male and female athletes. This success has had a ripple effect throughout the Olympic world, as women are now entrusted with greater responsibilities in sports management and the promotion of Olympism. The IOC now has observer status within the UN, after pushing for the recognition and adoption, by the UN General Assembly, of the unique



power of sport in peacebuilding. To this end, you initiated the 'Olympism 365' strategy, to which several partners and donors have signed up.

LASTING LEGACY

President BACH, you have bequeathed to the African Olympic Movement a lasting legacy. Your commitment to sport and Olympic values will have a positive impact on future generations of African sportsmen/women and leaders.

A major legacy you are bequeathing to us is the newly elected IOC President, Kirsty Coventry, the first woman to head the IOC, the first African, all thanks to you. This is indeed an honour for the African Olympic and Sports Movement.

THANK YOU, PRESIDENT THOMAS BACH

On behalf of ANOCA, I wish to convey our gratitude and admiration for your leadership and vision, which have contributed to shaping the future of Africa for years to come.

Mustapha Berraf

ANOCA President
IOC Member
ANOC Vice President
President of the Olympafrica Foundation

TRIBUTE



THOMAS BACH

A KEY ACTOR OF THE AFRICAN OLYMPIC DREAM



JULY 2024 / 3 JUILLET 2024
HOTEL MERIDIEN ET PARIS - FR

 **MR. MUSTAPHA BERRAF**
President

 **Dr. Robin E. Mitchell**
President ANOC



**Africa is grateful for
the lasting legacy
that Thomas BACH
is bequeathing to
the continent.**



IOC President Thomas BACH is commended for his role as a builder of the Olympic dream in Africa. Thanks to his leadership and vision, the IOC launched programmes and initiatives to support sport development on the continent.

The outgoing IOC boss demonstrated his commitment to Africa by working to build the capacities of African NOCs and encouraging the participation of African athletes in the Olympic Games.

Olympic and sporting Africa participated in the Olympic Games Tokyo 2020 and Paris 2024 with flying colours and total serenity thanks to his foresight. African athletes received Olympic grants thanks to Olympic Solidarity, which supported NOCs through ANOCA. This enabled African competitors and their coaches to take part in the Olympic Games in the best possible conditions. African performances have greatly improved at the international level.

The programmes launched by Olympic Solidarity have provided financial and technical support to African NOCs. This has made it possible to develop sports facilities, train coaches and athletes and promote Olympic values.

Africa is grateful for the lasting legacy that Thomas BACH is bequeathing to the continent.



THOMAS BACH

A DRIVING FORCE BEHIND MAJOR SPORTS PROJECTS IN AFRICA



UNVEILED BY
ENT OF
C COMMITTEE (IOC)
S BACH
NOVEMBER, 2019



ANOCA expresses its gratitude to President Thomas BACH for his unwavering support to the African Olympic Movement during his 12 years as IOC President.

ANOCA appreciates all his advice, actions and support for the African Olympic and Sports Movement. African youths received special attention and can look forward to the Youth Olympic Games Dakar 2026 in Senegal. The event was awarded to Africa under the leadership of Thomas BACH, a success story of African sports diplomacy with his support.

ANOCA has introduced new sports competitions on the continent, such as the African Beach Games and the School Games, with the support of Thomas BACH.

He was personally present for the commissioning of the new ANOCA headquarters in Abuja in November 2019.

President BACH thus worked to promote Olympic values and develop sport in Africa.

His commitment to Olympic Africa has been exemplary and has driven significant progress.

He visited several countries in Africa, strengthening ties between the IOC and the African Olympic and Sports Movement.

ANOCA would like to thank President BACH for his legacy to the African Olympic Movement. His dedication and commitment will have a positive impact on future generations of African athletes and leaders.

Thank you, President BACH!







THOMAS BACH

"THE ARCHITECT"







Africa hails the exceptional contribution of IOC President Thomas BACH to the promotion of sport and Olympic values on the continent.

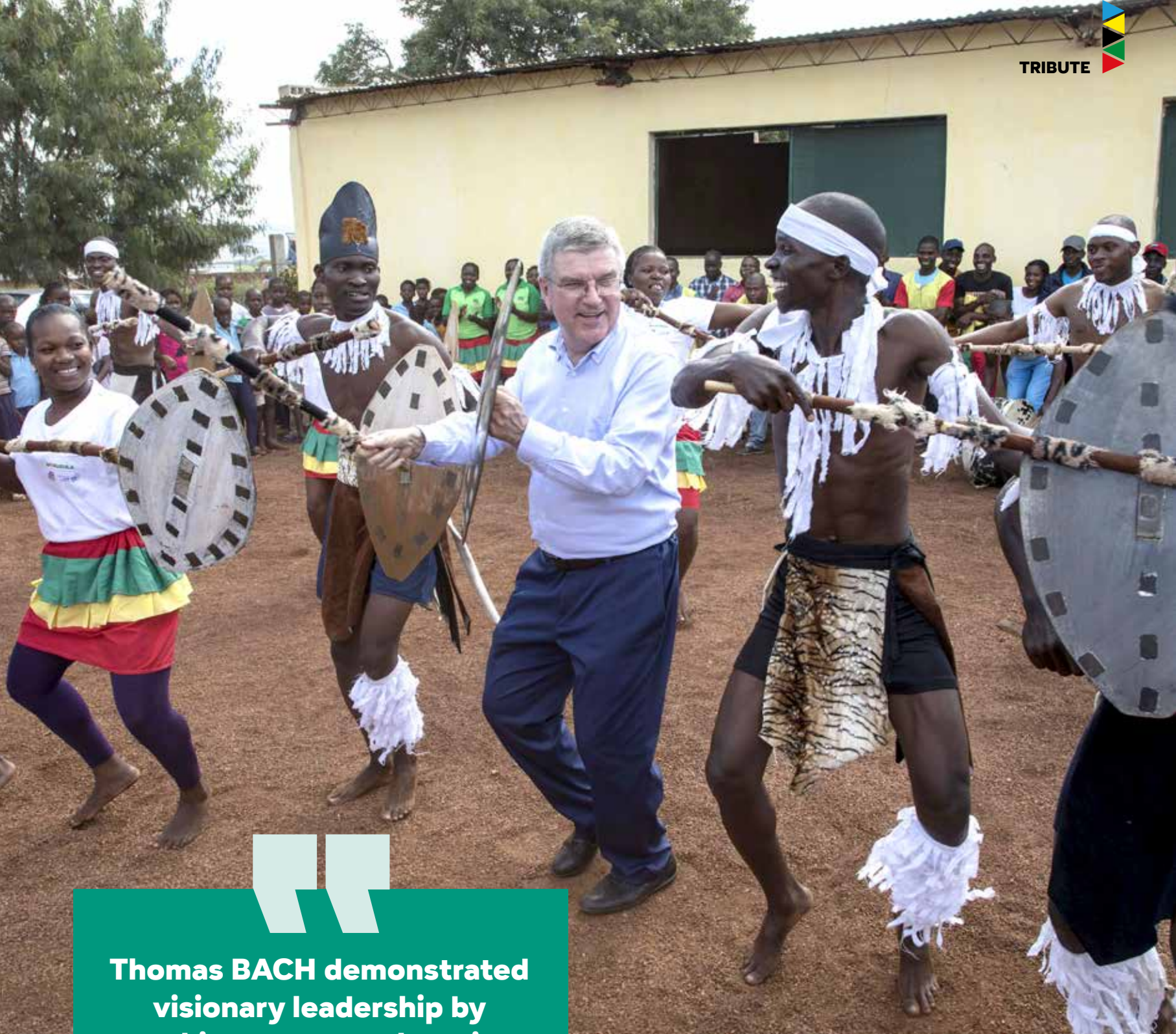
Under his stewardship, the IOC developed programmes and initiatives to support sport development in Africa, mainly through Olympic Solidarity.

Thomas BACH demonstrated visionary leadership by working to strengthen ties between African NOCs and the IOC. He also supported the participation of African athletes in the Olympic Games, promoted results-based governance and encouraged the promotion of Olympic values such as excellence, friendship and respect.

Africa is pleased and takes pride in this special attention. The continent is constantly building its reputation and geopolitical influence, and this also involves sport as a unifying force.

The fight against social inequalities, the promotion of health through sport, women's empowerment (entrusting them with positions of responsibility in sports governance), and the fight against idleness among youths are the key priorities of Olympic and sporting Africa.

Thomas BACH understood this and supported Africa in its many challenges. He has been nick-named "*Thomas BACH the African.*" And he is indeed a worthy Ambassador to international sports bodies. Africa pays tribute to him for this commitment.



Thomas BACH demonstrated visionary leadership by working to strengthen ties between African NOCs and the IOC.

He would like to see Africa organise the Olympic Games. This is the wish of the entire continent, and one that will certainly be fulfilled in the visionary perspective developed by Thomas BACH.





TRIBUTE



THOMAS BACH'S LEGACY TO THE AFRICAN OLYMPIC AND SPORTS MOVEMENT







Thomas BACH, outgoing IOC President, has left a lasting legacy on the African Olympic and Sports Movement. During his term of office, he worked to strengthen ties with African NOCs and design programmes to support sport development on the continent.

Thomas BACH forged strong bonds with African NOCs, and worked to understand their needs and challenges. He also encouraged the participation of African athletes in the Olympic Games and supported the promotion of Olympic values in Africa.

Under Thomas BACH's leadership, the IOC made significant strides in Africa, including the:

Implementation of financial and technical support programmes for African NOCs

- Development of sports facilities
- Training of African coaches and athletes
- Promotion of Olympic values in Africa

Thomas BACH's impact on the African Olympic and Sports Movement has been positive and lasting. His commitment to sport and Olympic values has helped to shape the future of African sport for years to come.



Every generation of leaders of the African Olympic and Sports Movement must build on and consolidate Thomas BACH's legacy. African NOCs and the IOC must continue to work together to promote sport and Olympic values in Africa.

Africa would like to thank Thomas BACH for his dedication and commitment to sport and Olympic values, which have helped to shape the future of African sport for years to come, and for his legacy, which will be etched in our memories.



**"12 YEARS OF
SUPPORT TO
AFRICA!"**



Thomas BACH's twelve-year stint as IOC President was marked by unwavering support for Olympic Africa.

He understood the needs and challenges of African countries and initiated development programmes. His main goal was to consolidate ties between the IOC and African NOCs.

During his tenure, the IOC increased Olympic Solidarity funding, and the latter also pushed for active participation of IOC members in Africa in decision-making bodies, thereby promoting more equitable and inclusive representation. This of course gave Africa a stronger voice within the global Olympic and Sports Movement.

He travelled across the world to promote Olympic values and ensure the sustainability of the Olympic spirit, which makes solidarity the first legacy of global sport.

Africa's concerns were considered in Thomas BACH's agenda. During the Covid-19 pandemic, he provided substantial support to athletes who were inactive during the long period of confinement. African athletes thus benefited from this support and are immensely grateful to him.

Thomas BACH did not only stand by Africa in the most delicate moments, but also lent his support whenever African youths were being celebrated.





TESTIMONIES







Engr. HABU AHMED GUMEL

IOC Honorary Member and ANOCA
Treasurer General



"As an African sports administrator who has served the Olympic Movement for several decades, I would like to express my deep gratitude to President Thomas BACH for his exceptional commitment to sport development in Africa. During his tenure, the IOC consolidated its ties with Africa, notably through increased Olympic Solidarity funding, which supported a great deal of African athletes and sports projects. President BACH was present for the commissioning of the new ANOCA headquarters in Abuja, Nigeria, in November 2019, which truly symbolised the IOC's commitment to the African continent. The choice of Dakar as host city of the 2026 Youth Olympic Games is a milestone that reflects the IOC's confidence in Africa's potential. President BACH also pushed for active participation of IOC members in Africa in decision-making bodies,

thereby promoting more equitable and inclusive representation. This, of course, gave Africa a stronger voice within the global Olympic and Sports Movement. His visionary leadership helped foster the Olympic values of respect, excellence and solidarity across the continent, contributing to youth development in Africa through sport. A staunch advocate of women's empowerment in sport, he did not only stand for gender equality, but also for equal opportunities, total inclusion and respect for diversity at all levels. On a personal note, I am honoured to have worked with President BACH and to have witnessed firsthand the positive changes and giant strides made by African sport under his tenure. I sincerely thank him for his dedication and unwavering support to sport development in Africa, for which he will always be remembered."

Mrs FILOMENA FORTES

IOC Member,
Second Vice President of ANOCA



"As an individual IOC member, I would like to pay a sincere and heartfelt tribute to President Thomas BACH, an iconic figure, who has deeply impacted the global Olympic movement by dint of his unwavering commitment. Under his enlightened leadership, the IOC has not only expanded its reach, but has, above all, been able to focus on essential causes of our time. Africa owes him a special debt of gratitude for his unwavering support to sport development on the continent, for the investments in human capital and other structural investments he encouraged, and for his inclusive vision that opens doors and creates opportunities. President BACH has also been a staunch advocate of women's

empowerment in sport, promoting equal opportunities and respect for diversity at the highest level. With deep gratitude, I acknowledge the honour he bestowed on me by entrusting me with the responsibility of being an individual IOC member. His confidence has been a source of inspiration and constant motivation for me. During successive Olympic Games, and the many activities we were both involved in, it was a privilege to work alongside a visionary leader, a man who is profoundly humane, with a listening ear, and who is faithful to the values of Olympism. Thank you, President BACH, for your dedication, your trust and your invaluable legacy."



IOC Member



Thomas Bach, my dear friend, brother, mentor and outgoing President of the International Olympic Committee (IOC), has been a true champion and living embodiment of the Olympic spirit. From the moment we met, his unwavering dedication and passion deeply moved me, transforming into an enriching and unlikely friendship. Under his leadership, the Olympic values have flourished, and every member of the Olympic family has been empowered to grow-both professionally and personally.

While his tenure is marked by remarkable achievements, his most enduring commitments have been his unwavering support to advance sport and promote Olympic values across Africa. Bach has boldly declared that "*Africa deserves to host the Olympic Games*" encouraging African nations to bid for future Games and championed key reforms including the Olympic Agenda 2020+5, aiming to reduce the cost of hosting and promote the use of existing infrastructure.

President Bach has gone beyond policy by making numerous visits to African nations-including Kenya, Lesotho, Senegal, South Africa, and Uganda-to engage directly with National Olympic Committees, athletes, and government leaders. Throughout, he has remained steadfast in his belief in sport as a catalyst for development, health, and education, consistently providing unwavering support and guidance to African-led initiatives that foster peace and progress through sport. He has celebrated the achievements

of African athletes and championed projects like the Olympic Refugee Foundation's "*Game Connect*," which uses sport to promote mental health, well-being, and social inclusion for refugees.

A landmark achievement, and a powerful testament to President Bach's advocacy for Africa is the upcoming Youth Olympic Games in Dakar, Senegal in 2026. This historic event will mark the first time an Olympic event is held on African soil, placing the continent firmly in the global Olympic spotlight. He has tirelessly championed Dakar 2026, viewing it as a catalyst for lasting growth, and a demonstration of Africa's rising importance in the Olympic Movement. He has long believed that this move would inspire a new generation of African athletes, and ignite broader investment in sport, infrastructure, and youth development across the continent.

Thomas is a man whose legacy is defined by a steadfast commitment to Olympic values and solidarity. He has empowered African sport by expanding opportunities for athletes, strengthening infrastructure and events across the continent, and championing Africa's rightful place within the global Olympic Movement.

With his ambitious vision, what once felt like a distant dream is now within our reach - bringing Africa ever closer to its moment on the world's Olympic stage.

Thank you for everything, my dear brother and friend, Thomas.





Mr SAM RAMSAMY

ANOCA Ethics
Commission Chair



“Thomas Bach departs as the President of the International Olympic Committee (IOC) on 23 June 2025.”

His twelve years in Office have been most extraordinary. His predecessor, Jacques Rogge, stabilised the Olympic Movement; and Thomas Bach had the challenge to steer the Movement to the next stage.

This, he did superbly well, despite unforeseen events like doping issues in Russia, Covid-19 Pandemic and Ukraine-Russia conflict.

Immediately after his election in 2013, Bach formulated Agenda 2020. It contained 40 detailed recommendations basically to reinforce the role of sport in modern day society.

Agenda 2020 was adopted by the IOC at its 2014 Session in Monaco. He foresaw the evolving changes in society and the challenges ahead. There, he declared:

“We need to change because sport today is too important in society to ignore the rest of society. We are not living on an island, we are living in the middle of a modern diverse, digital society.”



We need to change because sport today is too important in society to ignore the rest of society. We are not living on an island, we are living in the middle of a modern diverse, digital society.

Bach emphasised the importance of Unity in Diversity:

“This diversity is an enrichment ... because at the same time you strengthened the unity with regard to our vision and our values.”

With all the recommendations active and alive, we have observed the benefits in a multitude of ways. New sports taking into consideration of youth participation and innovations. Sport Climbing, Skating, Mixed Relays and inclusion of the Immigrants Team, to mention a few.

Suspension of Russian teams from participation in the Olympic Games because of doping issues and violation of the Olympic Truce and later for incorporating Ukraine territory into its Olympic Committee, was handled firmly and diplomatically.

The Covid-19 pandemic created a gigantic dilemma for the holding of the Games in Tokyo and Beijing. But the Games were held successfully under strict and careful compliance of all health regulations.

Africa was always a major focus of attention for Thomas Bach. His vision was always clear and ambitious. His support and encouragement have led to the strengthening of the African Sports Movement. The total unity of the African Olympic Movement, now established by President Mustapha Berraf, inspired Thomas Bach to increase support for African athletes and National Olympic Committees in numerous projects under the supervision of ANOCA. Further, the election of Kirsty Coventry as IOC President would, no doubt, continue with the programme for Africa.



Mrs GABY AHRENS

ANOCA Athletes
Commission Chair



“As an Olympian from Africa I’ve seen firsthand how your mission to give underrepresented regions a stronger voice has made the Olympic Movement more inclusive and truly global. Even with your many responsibilities, I felt seen and appreciated by you-and that meant more than you know. Your legacy will be felt for generations to come. Thank you for everything.”



Mr MEHREZ BOUSSAYENE

IOC Member and
President of NOC Tunisia

THOMAS BACH
**FIVE RINGS, FIVE
CONTINENTS, ONE
PLANET... FOREVER!**



His fight for peace, the IOC, the Olympic Movement and sport is one that goes on every day, 365 days a year.

Devoted like a tireless soldier serving a noble cause, and enduring like a champion in an ongoing quest for victory, Thomas BACH, elected Honorary IOC President for Life after twelve wonderful years at the helm of our organisation, is leaving us, but not for good, bequeathing a precious and unforgettable legacy to the international sporting and Olympic community and all of Humanity.

As he prepares to pass on the relay baton, he is owed a debt of gratitude, particularly for ensuring the continuity of the Games and elevating the Olympic Movement to the status of a leading force for tolerance, solidarity, development and peace, despite an international geopolitical situation marked by tension, turbulence, conflict and war, coupled with a health pandemic and the threat of climate change.

With his unshakable faith in the unique power of sport and the unequalled nobility of Olympic values, Thomas BACH honoured with admiration the IOC's iconic symbol of the five interlocking rings linking the five continents. For him, this symbol would only have real meaning if it is translated into concrete action on the ground, and if the five continents regain their right to host both the Olympic Games and the world's athletes on an equal basis.

It is around this inspiring idea that he built his vision through Olympic Agenda 2020 and later Olympic Agenda 2020+5, making Man more credible the Movement he led more robust.

In twelve years, he made the unifying power of sport to triumph, securing Rio 2016 in the Americas, then,

against all odds, Tokyo 2020+1 in Asia, followed by the extraordinary Paris 2024 Games in Europe after ensuring that the Games are hosted in Oceania via Brisbane 2032. He will definitely attend the YOG Dakar 2026, an opportunity afforded Africa to pay him a heartfelt tribute because he had wanted the Games to be held for the first time in Africa, and Africa is finally going to do so. More than just a symbol, the five rings uniting the five continents, are a reality that will forever bear his imprint.

Can the principle of the Universality of the Games be better expressed? Did he not also work relentlessly to achieve gender parity for the first time at the Paris 2024 Games? Did he not also further enshrine the Value of Inclusion by creating the Olympic Refugee Team, now the 207th regular delegation at the Games?

For Thomas BACH, as for all of us today, the Olympic Games are a haven of solidarity and peace, a crossroads for all of Humanity, where all genders, all races, all religions and all trends live side by side, holding high, ever higher, the indestructible banner of Sport.

Through sport, the Games and Olympic values, Thomas BACH has always been and will always be a soldier for peace. He has never stopped proclaiming '*Give Peace a chance*', to the point of having this unique power of sport recognised and adopted by the UN General Assembly, where the IOC was granted observer status thanks to its President.

His fight for peace, the IOC, the Olympic Movement and sport is one that goes on every day, 365 days a year in line with the Olympism365 Strategy initiated by Thomas BACH with the support of several funding partners.

The future of the Olympic Movement has, therefore, been mapped out and it is now up to all of us to protect and continue to build it together with our new President, two-time Olympic champion Kirsty COVENTRY, the first woman and the first African to



occupy this position. This is yet another achievement for Thomas BACH, the IOC and our Movement.

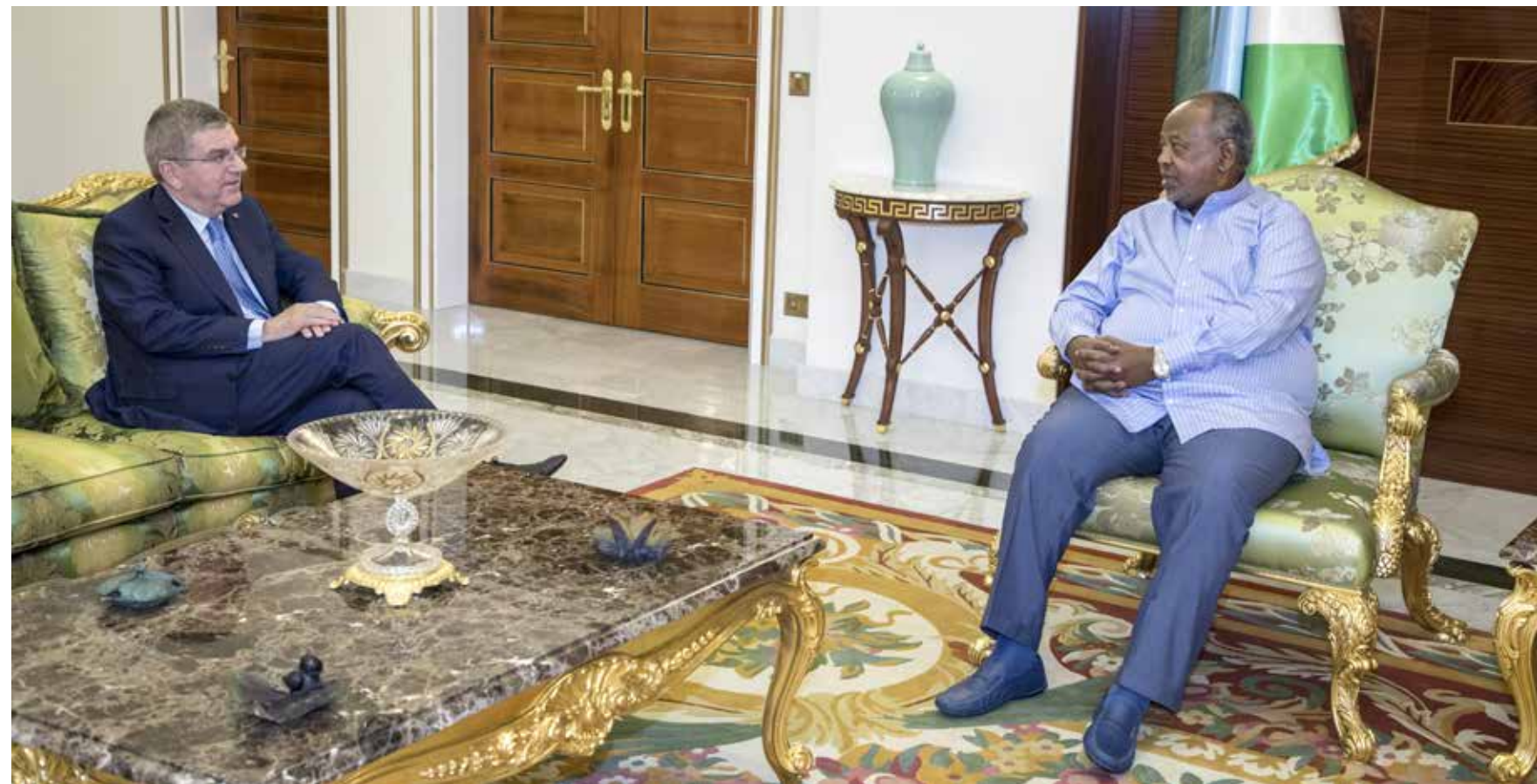
President, I doff you my hat! Thank you, Thomas! Hello Champion!

THOMAS BACH
IN PICTURES





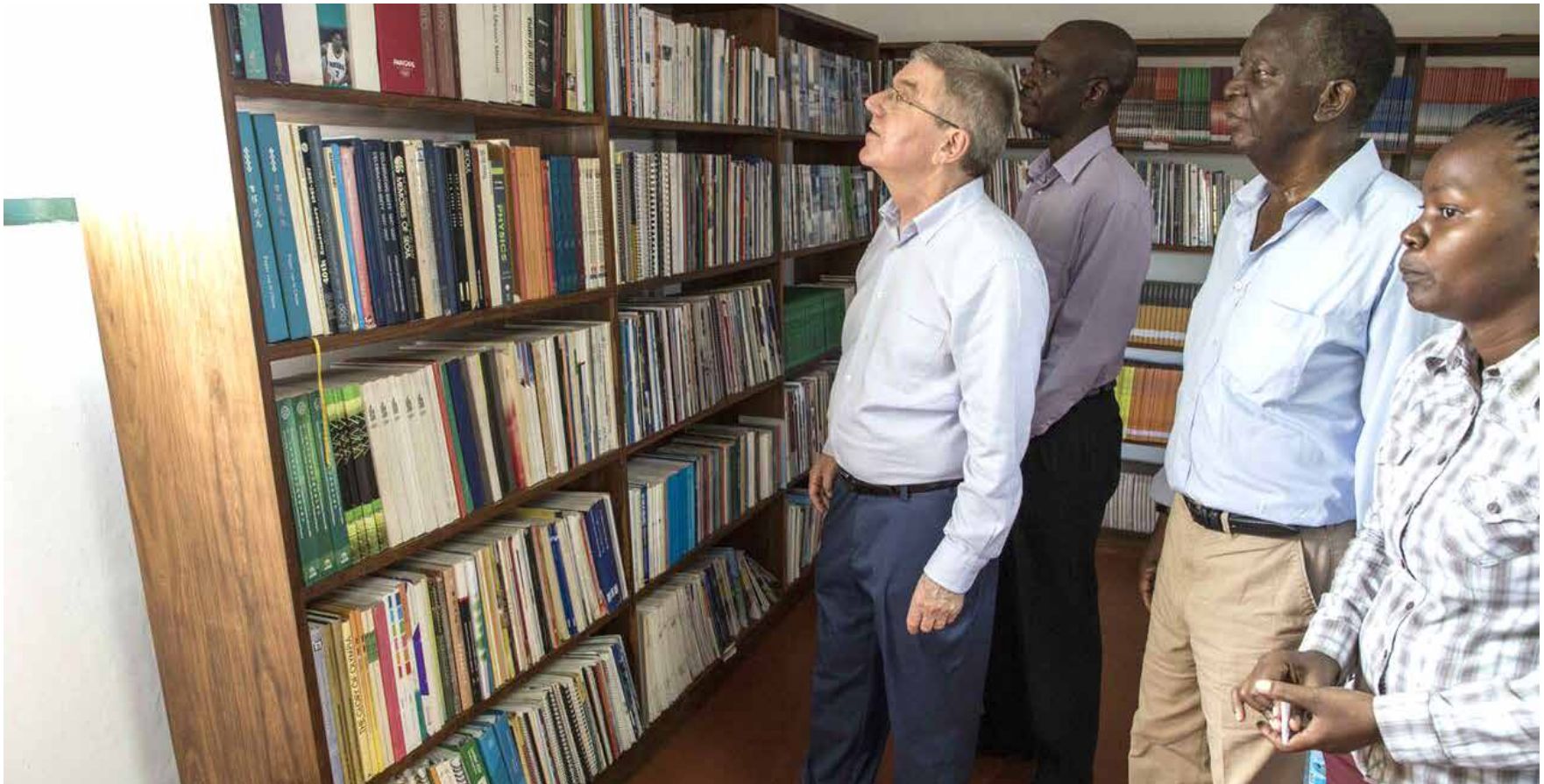




























*Sport is not just
about competition, it
is a powerful tool for
peace, cohesion and
social inclusion.*

Thomas Bach





Association
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of Africa

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THANK YOU
Thomas Bach